John Mahood School Council

Meeting Minutes October 9th, 2024

Present:

In Person:
Pam Mustin
Kristin Dorscht
Laura Fehrenbach
Emily McConnell
Krista Weltz
Bethany Metzger
Darrel Schinkel
Angie Melchin
Matt Dietrich
Kandis Walker

Online:
Leah Cressman
Alicia McGuire
Tabatha Nicholson
Meaghan Hachey

Voting Members Absent:
Courtney Dyer
Anupama Kanakathidam
Stephanie Remperl

Territorial Acknowledgement - Pam

Discussion of Previous Minutes - Kristen/Stephanie

- See last month's minutes Here
    - Accepted by - Kandis
    - Seconded by - Laura

Election of the 2024/2025 School Council

- Chair/Co-Chairs: Kristen Dorscht & Laura Fehrenbach
- Vice Chair: Stephanie Rempel
- Secretary: Mary Blanchard
- Treasurer: Katie Armstrong
- Social Media: Vacant
- Fundraising: Emily McConnel
- Volunteer Coordinator: Darrel Schinkel
- Voting Members: Alicia McGuire, Kandis Walker, Tabatha Nicholson, Meaghan Hachey, Angie Melchin, Matt Dietrich, Bethany Metzger, Kacheena Morrison,

Principal's Report - Pam

- Emergency Drills - Legally required to do 4 fire drills, one lockdown, a fire bomb drill - all have been successfully completed. Best time was 1-½ minutes.
- April will have a tornado drill and another lockdown drill
- Franco Ontario Day - Green and White Day, first time doing it, important to recognize in a French Immersion school. Kids did announcements in both english and french
- Terry Fox Run - huge success

    - Successful event.
    - Learned to have it more structured next year
    - Try and do more things like this to get families into the school
    - Fundraised approx. $4750
    - Soak the teacher day to be post-poned to next week
- First Assembly next Friday
    - Terry Fox, school song, presentation from student who cut hair to raise money
- Right to Read screening
    - EERT (Early reading resource teacher) in to help do reading screening K-2
    - Results of those screeners will result in how the EERT will come back and support
- First PD Day Friday
    - MAAP Math achievement action plan
    - Tiered approach to teaching math
    - K-2 teachers to do Acadiens livestream
    - 3-6 teachers self directed literacy
- Next PD Day Nov. 1st
- School Day next week
    - Terry Fox Assembly
    - Halloween - the day is focussed around the curriculum, no parties
        - Kids may dress as they wish, as long as it is appropriate, no masks allowed
- Individual EQAO results to come home soon

Chair's Report - Kristen

- WRAPSC Meeting last week
    - Talked about playgrounds
    - WRAPSC may be asking for each school to vote about incidents where children have witnessed
- Pizza days 590 slices per week
- Nutrition for Learning Meeting - Laura attended
    - 6 people attended
    - Funding drastically cut across the board
    - Amount from ministry hasn't changed in 14 years
    - $0.03 per day per student
    - Hoping school councils can support
    - If $200 families in the school gave $5 per month it would help offset the deficit
    - Loose change fundraiser was successful in the past
    - Brainstorm needed on how to fund it
    - Leanne orders the food through nutrition for learning
    - Cheese strings, hard boiled eggs, veggies, crackers, granola bars, etc

    - Send paper home, social media etc - post soon
    - Mary and Laura will start working on a handout
    - Idea to have $0.25 per pizza slice go towards Nutrition for Learning - possibly up pizza slice by $0.25 - revisit in New year
    - **Motion to run online and loose change campaign for nutrition for learning - Kristen**
        - **Passed by Majority Vote**
- Skating Party - date is booked, form to be signed by Pam and Leanne
    - January 18th 3-5pm
    - Ice for two hours, room for 3 hours
    - Planning committee to get started soon
- Mahoodfest - tentative date of ~~Tuesday May 27th~~ **Tuesday May 13th (revised due to scheduling conflict)**
    - Planning to begin in January - separate committee
    - Will be looking for helpers

Teachers report - Krista

- Kodaly starting grade 4 and up - 25 kids signed up
    - Kitchener Rangers - we are on a waitlist, possibly friday of March break, first in line for playoffs
    - Possibly sing a Sugar Kings
- SKs had their fire truck visit
- Eco club has begun
- Bucket drumming
- Harmonica
- More arts back in the school
- Field trips are happening

Treasury Report - Kristen

- Pizza profit about $3000
- $216 profit from Mabels Labels
- $17,375 to spend this year

Fundraising & Community Engagements

- Poinsettias
    - Selling from Oct. 29 - Nov. 12th
    - Pickup date Wednesday November 27th at 1pm
    - Need to book library
    - Red white and pink in four different sizes

    - Orders on school-day and and order form in the staff room
- Baden Coffee
    - Too soon to book for the fall, but lots of availability in 2025
    - A very profitable fundraiser
- Cornerstore Candy
    - Bags of gummies and candy, sm, med, large
    - Availability after Feb 15th
- **Motion to run coffee and candy fundraiser in the new year - Kristen**
    - **Passed by Majority vote**
- Maggies mudroom didn't respond, look into other art night
- Bingo booked for April 3
    - All we need to do is cleanup chairs at the end of the night

Funding Initiatives and yearly focus

- Wishlist from school
    - Recess equipment
    - Guest speakers
    - Subsidize harmonicas, recorders etc
    - Decodable books - home reading program
    - Theme of providing equity for kids - student success and support
    - "Here for All"
- **Motion to have "Here for All" to be used for our fundraising theme for the year**
    - **Passed by Majority Vote**
- Funding request form and formal process
    - If teachers would like something, or a club would need something they put in a form Gets reviewed by Chair and Principal and then presented to council to be voted on
- Traditionally school council has approved a number of items in past years, idea to vote on these items now, so that votes are not required later
    - Pancake Day - $150
    - Holiday rotation day - hot chocolate - $125
    - Jump rope for heart - freezies - $50
    - Track and field - freezies $50
    - Kindie concert $125
    - **Motion to approve $425 spending for the above annual events - Kristen**
        - **Passed by majority vote**
    - Classroom spend $300 to each classroom, rotary teachers, EA support teach and Leanne

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        - **Motion to approve classroom spend for $300 per class and staff member up to a maximum of $7800 - Kristen**
        - **Passed by Majority vote**
    - Grade six year end celebration and trip
        - **Motion to approve $1000 for grade six camp and celebration - Kristen**
        - **Passed by majority vote**
    - Jungle Sport - comes to the school for the week and sets up a ropes course, it changes for different age groups
        - Kids love it and there is major participation
        - **Motion to support the whole jungle sport for $5000 - Kristen**
            - **Not Passed**
        - **Motion to support half of Jungle Sport for $2500 and to discuss how the other half gets paid for as the year goes on - Kristen**
            - **Passed by Majority Vote**

Open Discussion - All

- Lunch helpers - teachers do supervise at lunch
    - Some kids are eager to help
- Stacked pancake school lunch program - something to discuss later
- Moving meetings to 4th Wednesday of the month

Next meeting

- November 27th @ 6:30 in the Library and online

Additional discussion / activities after the meeting

- **Motion to host a sign making workshop at the school on Monday Dec 16th at 6:30-8:30 pm. Cost is $30-$50 per sign with 25% from each being donated back to the school - Motion by Kristen/Emily**
    - **Passed by Majority Vote**
- Social Media position was filled and will be shared by Kristen and Katie.